

hat Parliament is supreme"

agenda should be restoration of the judiciary that was sacked by the previous government.

A. I think it is a very small thought. I think we need a larger solution to this problem. We need to make the judiciary independent—financially too. Then we need to lay down the parameters of what the judiciary's functions are. For too long in our history we have suffered when the judiciary took on itself to destabilise the government. So we have to be very careful and, therefore, I feel there should be an open debate in Parliament, every single judge should be whetted by Parliament and only then should they be appointed.

Q. If Sharif insists on sticking to his agenda, then what?

A. I think his agenda will coincide with our agenda. He will come around to the power of Parliament.

Q. Will you be able to work

with President Musharraf?

A. I will be working with Parliament. It is the sovereign governing body of the country. In a constitutional democracy a president has a limited role. I will ensure that Parliament is supreme.

Q. What about suggestions to impeach President Musharraf?

A. Let Parliament decide. We are getting carried away by slogans rather

than going to the crux of the job. The beef is in strengthening democracy.

Q. What is the mandate of this election?

A. I think the mandate is for democracy and against fundamental forces and the previous government.

Q. Not against Musharraf?

A. Isn't he a part of it?

Q. Will you ask Musharraf to step down?

A. Why don't we let Parliament decide and see if it can do it. If it can't then let everyone cut his cloth according to his size.

Q. Who would be PPP's prime minister?

A. It is a settled issue. We will put an agenda on the table and see which of our seniormost parliamentarians will fit the bill.

Q. Not you?

A. No. Because I think the party is more important. There is too much protocol for the prime minister to be able to do party work along with his duties. We have been together to the prime minister's house twice. We don't want to go there again.

Q. How do you see relations with India?

A. I see a great potential. We are a small country compared to India but we are a large supporter of it. India can be a super economic power if we do things together.



AP PHOTO

"Why don't we let Parliament decide and see if it can get Musharraf to step down. If it can't then let everyone cut his cloth according to his size."

Map by PUSHVINDER KAUR, Text by HASAN ZAIDI

PROVINCES



The provinces, especially Punjab, hold the key to power arrangements at the Centre

PUNJAB

Total Seats: 297

COALITION

PML(N): 104

+

PPP: 77

NWFP

Total Seats: 99

COALITION

ANP: 31+

PPP: 18+

Independents: 17

SINDH

Total Seats: 130

SIMPLE MAJORITY*

PPP: 66

BALUCHISTAN

Total Seats: 51

COALITION

PML(Q): 16+

Independents and

Others: 16

*MQM may also become part of the government; NWFP: North West Frontier Province

Map not to scale